

Chapter 1

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet Chapter 1: Introduction to Career Planning

Instructions: Complete each section by engaging in the activities provided (or adapt them to your preference if needed). Be honest and thoughtful; this is for your personal growth. Set aside 30-45 minutes in a quiet space to focus.

Part 1: Understanding the Overall Career Planning Process

Reflect on the career planning process outlined in Chapter 1 (Self-Assessment, Research and Exploration, Goal Setting, Action Planning, Review and Adjust).

- **Process Ranking Activity:** Rank the five steps of the career planning process from 1 (most challenging) to 5 (least challenging) based on how you feel about them right now. Then, circle the one you're most excited to start.
 - Self-Assessment: _____
 - Research and Exploration: _____
 - Goal Setting: _____
 - Action Planning: _____
 - Review and Adjust: _____
- **Quick Commitment:** Check one small action you can take this week related to any step of the process. [] Take a personality or interest quiz online (Self-Assessment) [] Watch a short video about a career that interests me (Research) [] Write down one career goal on a sticky note (Goal Setting) [] Tell a friend or mentor about a career idea (Action Planning) [] Reflect on a past decision that worked or didn't (Review and Adjust)

Part 2: Importance of Career Planning

Consider why career planning matters, as discussed in Chapter 1 (direction, clarity, adaptability, fulfillment, long-term growth).

- **Benefits Matching Game:** Match each benefit of career planning to how it might help you personally by drawing a line between them. Then, star (*) the one that resonates with you most right now.
 - Direction → Helps me avoid feeling lost
 - Clarity → Helps me understand what I really want
 - Adaptability → Helps me adjust to unexpected changes
 - Fulfilment → Helps me find work I enjoy
 - Long-term Growth → Helps me build skills for the future

- **Quick Vote:** If you had to pick one reason career planning is important at your stage of life, which would it be? Check one. ☐ To avoid wasting time on the wrong path ☐ To feel more confident about the future ☐ To find work that matches who I am ☐ Other: _____

Part 3: Key Elements of Career Planning

Focus on critical elements like self-awareness, informed decision-making, and debunking myths from Chapter 1.

- **Self-Awareness Checklist:** Check off any strengths or interests you're aware of that could influence your career choices. Add one more if you think of something unique. ☐ Good at solving problems ☐ Enjoy working with people ☐ Love creative tasks (art, writing, design) ☐ Strong with numbers or data ☐ Prefer hands-on or physical work ☐ Other: _____
- **Curiosity Spark:** Pick one career or job role you're curious about. Circle one question below you'd like to explore about it (or write your own). Career/Role: _____ Question to Explore:
 - What's a typical day like in this job?
 - What skills do I need to start?
 - How much does it pay at the entry level?
 - Other: _____
- **Myth-Busting Reflection:** Circle one career planning myth from Chapter 1 that you've heard or believed. Then, check the box if knowing the truth makes you feel more relieved or motivated.
 - "You Must Choose One Career for Life"
 - "A High-Paying Job Equals Success"
 - "Career Planning Is Only for 'Serious' People"
 - "You Need a College Degree for a Good Career" ☐ I feel more relieved/motivated knowing the truth

Part 4: Initial Aspirations and Fears

Explore your personal vision and concerns about career planning as inspired by the activity "Defining Personal Career Success" and other chapter insights.

- **Success Vision Board Idea:** Instead of writing, imagine a vision board for your career success. Check up to three elements you'd include on it that represent success to you. ☐ A specific job title or role ☐ A location (e.g., big city, nature, abroad) ☐ Work-life balance (e.g., time for hobbies/family) ☐ Making a difference (e.g., helping others) ☐ Financial stability or wealth ☐ Other: _____
- **Fear Identification Exercise:** Circle one fear or concern you have about career planning. Then, check one way you might address it. Fear:
 - Fear of failing or making the wrong choice
 - Not knowing where to start
 - Financial instability or low pay
 - Other: _____ Way to Address: ☐ Talk to someone who's been through it ☐ Start with a small, low-risk step ☐ Look up resources or success stories online ☐ Other: _____

Part 5: Action Plan and Reflection

Wrap up by setting a small goal and reflecting on your takeaways from this worksheet and chapter.

- **Action Commitment:** Check one specific action you will take within the next week to move forward with career planning. Write the day you'll do it. ☐ Take an online career quiz ☐ Talk to a friend, family member, or mentor about career ideas ☐ Search for one job or industry online ☐ Watch a TED Talk or video on career planning ☐ Other: _____ Deadline (specific day): _____
- **Insight Snapshot:** Circle one key idea or insight from Chapter 1 or this worksheet that stands out to you. Then, check how it might influence your approach. Key Insight: _____

- Career planning is personal and flexible
- Self-awareness is the starting point
- It's okay to change paths over time
- Research helps avoid bad decisions
- Other: _____ Influence on Approach: [] I'll take it one step at a time [] I'll focus on what I value most [] I'll ask for help when needed [] Other: _____